Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort to make a pretty picture, violet often appears when we are looking for **something hard to name**. We do not always know why, though. Sometimes we know exactly why, sometimes not at all. Both are fine.

What can lie behind a violet stroke

The same violet area on paper can mean **something completely different each time**, depending on what is happening in us just then. That is why there is no point in reading a picture as a test with a single right answer.

Creativity and play.

Unusual shapes, bold combinations, a free movement of the hand. A colour that allows itself to be different.

Transcendence and silence.

Soft, scattered, light areas, often around the head or at the top of the paper. Something that cannot be grasped in words.

Longing and sensuality.

Soft, flowing lines, wine and plum tones. Warmth that does not hide.

Sadness and yearning.

Darker, cold areas, often low down, with slow strokes. Mourning that does not yet have words.

Pride and exceptionality.

Firm, striking shapes, often in the middle. A colour that wants to be seen.

Feeling different.

Violet alone among other colours, or an area that fits nowhere. A search for where my place is.

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Violet in a picture. Can it express what is happening inside?

Yes, it **can** – but it **does not have to**. When painting you sometimes reach for a colour before you can name what you feel. Violet can then give shape to the joy of trying, to silence, to sadness or to yearning. Equally it can simply be a **pretty colour** you happened to have at hand that day. It gains meaning only in connection with **your experience**. The colour itself does not know what happened to you. You do, or you will find out in time.

Art therapy also works with the idea that a picture can express something for which words are hard to find. What matters, though, is not one spot on the paper but the **whole picture** and how it came about. Your situation, memories, the movement of your hand and your feelings while painting. A predominance of violet alone **is not enough for a verdict** on whether it is depth or yearning. Maybe you wanted to allow yourself to be striking. Maybe the most beautiful tube simply fell into your hand.

What if I want to paint it but not wear it?

A picture and clothes may ask two completely different things of you. **A picture can bear your trial run** without you having to go shopping for it. On canvas you can give it enormous space and do not have to accept at the same time an idea of how you yourself will look in it.

Perhaps in it you allow yourself a boldness you do not yet want to show on your own body. Perhaps it is purely the difference between looking at a picture and wearing fabric. **When violet starts to delight you in clothing too, that will be fine.** And if not, it is not a required transfer of inner change into your wardrobe.

That is completely fine. Sometimes you want to wear it, sometimes only to paint it. Lilac on paper and a plum coat in a shop do not exclude each other, but they do not need to go together either.

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When violet takes over the space

First let your hand work. You do not have to paint a spiritual experience. When you reach for violet, **a universe, a mandala or a message does not have to appear**. It can happily become a large unnamed area. **The interpretation can wait.** And you do not have to choose the right reason before you touch the canvas.

Three things worth noticing

• QUANTITY

A large area or a small trace?

A large violet area can feel like something you want to sink into. It can also start to get too dense. A small trace can be precious, distant, or simply beautiful next to another colour. The amount of violet does not show the measure of your intuition or spirituality. What is interesting is how you feel next to that area. Do you want to stay, come closer, or step back?

• SATURATION

Velvet or air?

A dark plum has a different expression from a light lavender. When you add white, you are not necessarily "taking away depth". Maybe you are just looking for a form in which you feel more comfortable. Conversely, darkening can bring a feeling of fullness that was missing in the light picture.

• THICKNESS

Hold the mass or watch the translucency?

A thick layer can recall velvet or a solid wall. Thin paint spreads like ink and lets earlier layers show through. Notice which way of working draws you. You do not have to draw a conclusion about yourself from it.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter what a violet stroke looks like. What matters is what you feel in it and what is happening in your life at that moment. **Two identical pictures can have completely different meanings**. One was made in the joy of your own courage, the other after a day when you felt different and abandoned. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but **questions**.

A picture can speak even after time

Perhaps after a while you will notice that you returned to violet at a time when you lacked **transcendence**, **lightness** or the wish to be **different in your own way**. Perhaps you will connect it with a completely **different experience**. In self-reflective work inspired by art therapy a picture can serve as a trace of your own experience and a chance to look back.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at what you painted and it tells you nothing. In a week, a month or a year it may suddenly dawn on you: “Aha, this is what I was carrying in myself then.” That is fine. **The picture will wait until you are ready to understand it.**

Neither is wrong and neither is right. **Violet can hold joy and yearning** and often both in one picture.

If very strong or painful feelings appear while painting, **do not stay with them alone**. Talk about them with someone close or with a therapist. **This page does not replace professional care**.

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